Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs

December 12, 1937 to April 24, 1938

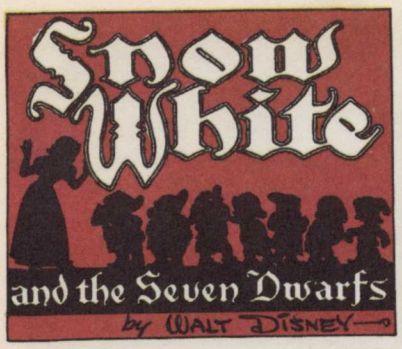



Snow White
and the Seven Dwarfs
by Walt Disney
ONCE UPON A TIME THERE WAS A LOVELY LITTLE PRINCESS NAMED SNOW WHITE -----
---- WHO WAS FORCED TO DRESS IN RAGS AND DO MENIAL WORK AROUND THE CASTLE -------
-----BY HER WICKED STEP-MOTHER, THE QUEEN!
QUEEN GRIMHILDE HAD A MAGIC MIRROR WHICH WOULD ANSWER ANY QUESTION SHE ASKED! AND, BEING VERY VAIN, SHE ALWAYS ASKED THE SAME QUESTION:
MIRROR, MIRROR, ON THE WALL, WHO IS THE FAIREST ONE OF ALL?
AND ALWAYS THE FACE IN THE MIRROR GAVE THE SAME REPLY:
YOU, MY QUEEN, ARE THE FAIREST ONE OF ALL!
SO THE QUEEN WOULD GO BACK TO HER THRONE, WHERE SHE SAT, ADMIRING HER BEAUTY!
I WON'T ALWAYS HAVE TO WORK SO HARD! SOME DAY A PRINCE WILL COME FOR ME!
DO YOU WANT TO SEE WHAT MY PRINCE WILL LOOK LIKE?
THERE HE IS! MY PRINCE! PRINCE BUCKETHEAD!
BUT, FROM A FAR COUNTRY, COMES AN ADVENTUROUS PRINCE WHO HAS HEARD OF SNOW WHITE'S BEAUTY!
WITHIN AN HOUR WE SHALL BE AT THE CASTLE--- AND OUR GREATEST ADVENTURE WILL START!
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TO BE CONTINUED--


Snow White
and the Seven Dwarfs
by Walt Disney
FORCED TO DRESS IN RAGS AND WORK IN THE COURTYARD, SNOW WHITE AMUSES HERSELF BY BUILDING AN IMAGINARY "PRINCE"!-
IT IS CHARMING OF YOU, PRINCE BUCKET-HEAD---TO COME ALL THIS WAY JUST TO SEE ME!
WHY, OF COURSE--I'D BE DELIGHTED TO GO TO THE BALL WITH YOU! SO SWEET OF YOU TO ASK ME!
WE SHALL LEAD THE GRAND MARCH! I'M SURE QUEEN GRIMHILDE WOULDN'T MIND!
WHAT'S THIS? DO MY EYES DECEIVE ME? SURELY, NO SCULLERY MAID COULD BE SO LOVELY!
PERHAPS I HAD BETTER INVESTIGATE!
SUCH A GORGEOUS GOWN! AND MY JEWELS ARE MOST BECOMING!
I'M SORRY I'M NOT MORE BEAUTIFUL, PRINCE BUCKETHEAD! I HOPE YOU'RE NOT DISAPPOINTED!
DISAPPOINTED? WHY---I'M ENCHANTED!
MERCY! I--I---I THOUGHT YOU ANSWERED ME! I--I MUST BE DREAMING!
NO, MY PRINCESS! IT IS I WHO MUST BE DREAMING!
12-19
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Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs

by Walt Disney















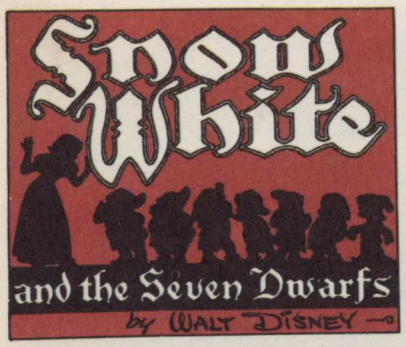




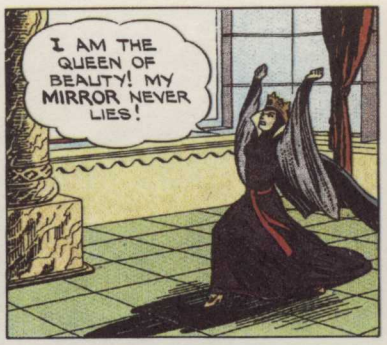








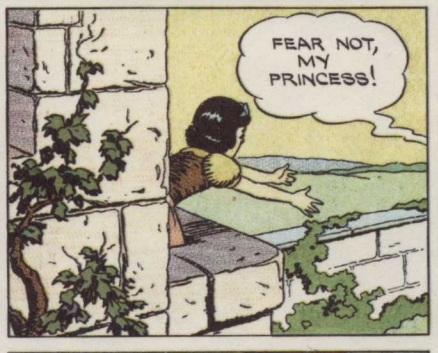























Snow White
and the Seven Dwarfs
by Walt Disney
THE WICKED QUEEN, INSANELY JEALOUS OVER SNOW WHITE'S BEAUTY, HAS CAST THE LITTLE PRINCESS' LOVER INTO THE DUNGEON. SHE THEN CALLS HER HUNTSMAN BEFORE HER.
YOU SENT FOR ME, YOUR MAJESTY?
I WISH YOU TO TAKE SNOW WHITE FOR A WALK--DEEP INTO THE FOREST!
YOU WILL FIND SOME SECLUDED GLADE -- AND THERE ---
---YOU WILL KILL HER!
YOUR MAJESTY! I CANNOT DO THAT! THE LITTLE PRINCESS---!
THE LIVES OF YOUR OWN CHILDREN ARE FORFEIT, IF YOU FAIL! DO YOU UNDERSTAND?
BUT TO MAKE DOUBLY SURE YOU DO NOT FAIL--- BRING BACK HER HEART IN THIS!
AS YOUR MAJESTY COMMANDS!
WHO KNOCKS?
IT IS HUMBERT, THE QUEEN'S HUNTSMAN, YOUR HIGHNESS!
HER MAJESTY THINKS YOU HAVE BEEN WORKING TOO HARD! SHE SUGGESTS A HOLIDAY--- A STROLL IN THE FOREST!
THE QUEEN-- SAID THAT?
I MIGHT DISTRUST THE QUEEN IF YOU WERE NOT WITH ME, HUMBERT! BUT I KNOW THAT YOU WILL LET NOTHING HARM ME!
1-9


Snow White
and the Seven Dwarfs
by Walt Disney
WHAT A GLORIOUS DAY! IT'S GOOD TO BE ALIVE!
---TO BE --ALIVE!
YOU DON'T SEEM HAPPY, HUMBERT! IS IT SUCH A TERRIBLE TASK TO GO WALKING WITH ME?
YOUR HIGHNESS! PLEASE DON'T! I--I--!
OH, LOOK! THE POOR LITTLE THING! IT MUST BE LOST!
DON'T YOU CRY--CHEER UP! YOUR MAMA AND PAPA CAN'T BE FAR AWAY!
SEE -- HERE THEY ARE NOW! CAN YOU FLY?
GOODBYE, LITTLE BIRD! GOODBYE!
OH-H-H!!
I CAN'T -- I CAN'T DO IT! FORGIVE ME, YOUR HIGHNESS, I BEG YOU!
BUT---I DON'T UNDER-STAND!
THE QUEEN! SHE'S MAD WITH JEALOUSY! SHE FORCED ME TO TAKE YOU HERE--TO--TO---!
----TO KILL ME?
YES! NOW, QUICK, CHILD, RUN! HIDE IN THE WOODS! ANYWHERE --BUT GO--GO!!
TERROR-STRICKEN, SNOW WHITE PLUNGES INTO THE DARK FOREST. HER ONLY THOUGHT IS TO HIDE WHERE THE QUEEN CAN NEVER FIND HER.
1-16

Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs

by Walt Disney

FRIGHTENED BY HER NARROW ESCAPE FROM DEATH, SNOW WHITE FLEES, TERRIFIED, INTO THE WOODS.

BLINDED WITH FEAR, SHE TRIPS AND FALLS.

IN HER GREAT FRIGHT, SNOW WHITE'S IMAGINATION CAUSES HER TO SEE FEARFUL MONSTERS SURROUNDING HER.

HARMLESS BUSHES TAKE THE FORM OF CLUTCHING HANDS....

....GNARLED TREE TRUNKS APPEAR AS GIGANTIC OGRES. THE EYES OF OWLS AND BATS ARE MAGNIFIED IN HER MIND TO THE EYES OF HORRIBLE DEMONS.

RUNNING BLINDLY, SHE STUMBLES INTO A SHALLOW POND.

AS SHE SCRAMBLES OUT, THE LITTLE PRINCESS THINKS SHE HAS BARELY ESCAPED THE GAPING MOUTHS OF CROCODILES.

OVERCOME BY FEAR, HER STRENGTH EXHAUSTED....

....SNOW WHITE FALLS, SOBBING, TO THE GROUND.

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Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs

by Walt Disney

SNOW WHITE STOPS CRYING, AS SHE SENSES MANY PAIRS OF CURIOUS EYES WATCHING HER.

OH!

HOW FOOLISH I'VE BEEN TO BE AFRAID OF THE WOODS! WHY, WE'RE GOING TO BE FRIENDS, AREN'T WE?

YOU SEE, I'LL HAVE TO LIVE IN THE WOODS LIKE YOU--IF I CAN FIND A PLACE TO STAY!

MAYBE YOU KNOW WHERE I CAN FIND A HOME?

YOU DO? WILL YOU TAKE ME THERE?

THE LITTLE FOREST CREATURES LEAD SNOW WHITE DEEPER INTO THE FOREST.

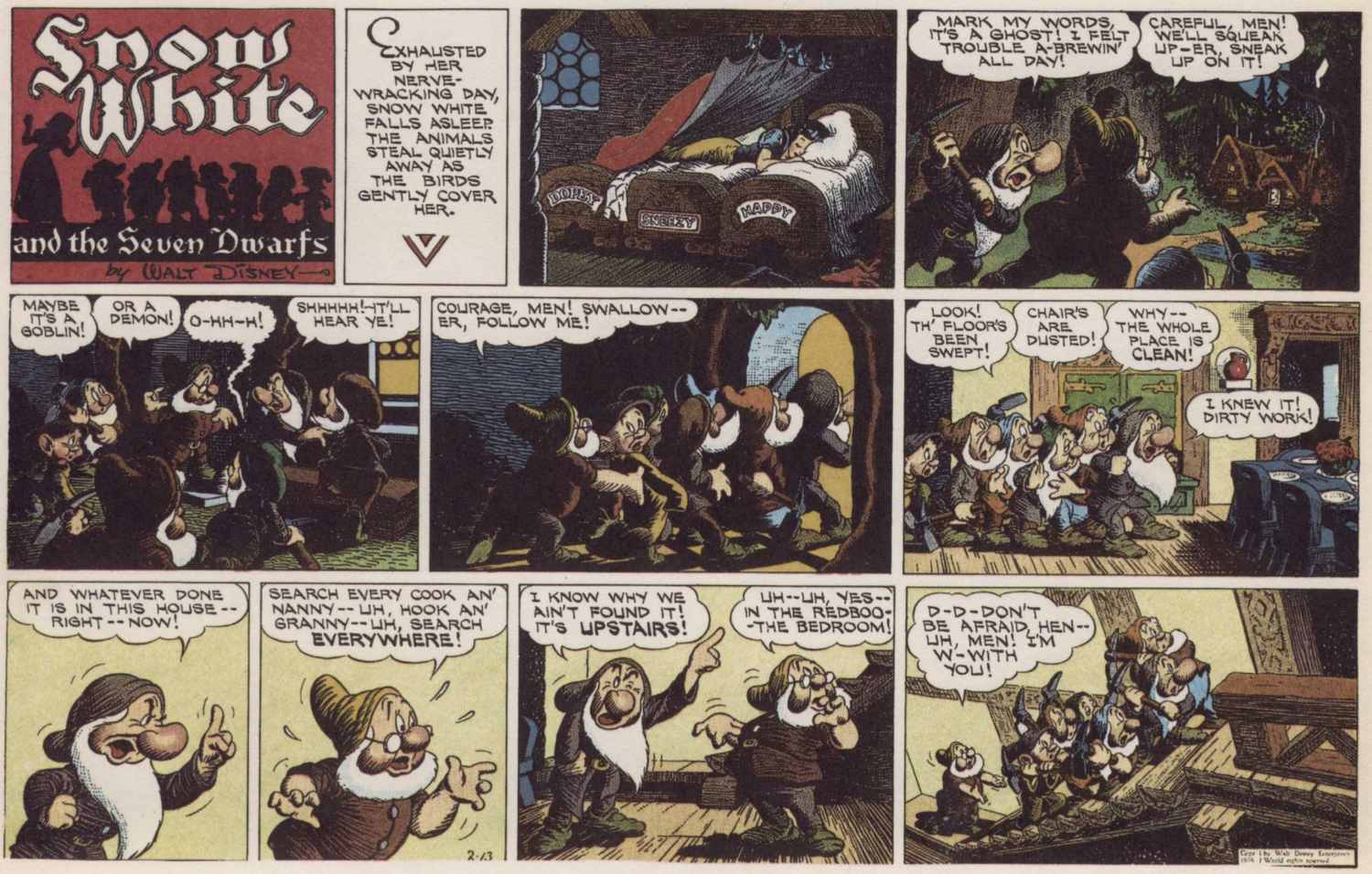
THEY PULL BACK THE BUSHES, AND THERE, IN A LITTLE CLEARING.....

OH, HOW ADORABLE!

I WONDER WHO LIVES IN THIS CUTE LITTLE HOUSE?

MEANWHILE, FROM THEIR MINE IN THE FOREST, SEVEN LITTLE MEN MARCH HOMEWARD.——


Snow White
and the Seven Dwarfs
by WALT DISNEY
GUESS THERE'S NOBODY HOME!
WHAT TINY LITTLE CHAIRS! THEY MUST BELONG TO CHILDREN!
CHILDREN! HOW WONDERFUL! I'LL STAY AND TAKE CARE OF THEM!
THEY CERTAINLY NEED SOMEONE TO TIDY UP THIS HOUSE!
NOW LET'S SEE WHAT'S UPSTAIRS!
DOC--GRUMPY! MY! WHAT FUNNY NAMES FOR CHILDREN!
DOPEY
SNEEZY
HAPPY
♪ HI HO! HI HO! ♪ IT'S HOME FROM WORK WE GO! ♪
LOOK! SOMEONE'S IN OUR HOUSE! THE LIT'S LIGHT--UH--THE LIGHT'S LIT!
2-6


Snow White
and the Seven Dwarfs
by WALT DISNEY
EXHAUSTED BY HER NERVE-WRACKING DAY, SNOW WHITE FALLS ASLEEP. THE ANIMALS STEAL QUIETLY AWAY AS THE BIRDS GENTLY COVER HER.
DOPEY
SNEEZY
HAPPY
MARK MY WORDS, IT'S A GHOST! I FELT TROUBLE A-BREWIN' ALL DAY!
CAREFUL, MEN! WE'LL SQUEAK UP-ER, SNEAK UP ON IT!
MAYBE IT'S A GOBLIN!
OR A DEMON!
O-HH-H!
SHHHHH!--IT'LL HEAR YE!
COURAGE, MEN! SWALLOW--ER, FOLLOW ME!
LOOK! TH' FLOOR'S BEEN SWEPT!
CHAIR'S ARE DUSTED!
WHY--THE WHOLE PLACE IS CLEAN!
I KNEW IT! DIRTY WORK!
AND WHATEVER DONE IT IS IN THIS HOUSE--RIGHT--NOW!
SEARCH EVERY COOK AN' NANNY--UH, HOOK AN' GRANNY--UH, SEARCH EVERYWHERE!
I KNOW WHY WE AIN'T FOUND IT! IT'S UPSTAIRS!
UH--UH, YES--IN THE REDBOO--THE BEDROOM!
D-D-DON'T BE AFRAID, HEN--UH, MEN! I'M W-WITH YOU!
2-13

Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs

by Walt Disney

GOSH! WHAT A MONSTER!

QUIET, MEN! WE'LL SURROUND IT!

SHHHH!—

DOPEY

SNEEZY

SUDDENLY SNOW WHITE STRETCHES AND YAWNS---

OH!

SLEEPY

WHY--'TAIN'T A MONSTER A'TALL!

UH--NO! IT'S, AHEM--- IT'S A GIRL!

EXCUSE ME FOR BEING SO STARTLED, BUT I EXPECTED TO SEE CHILDREN!

CHILDREN!

HEH! THAT'S ALL THE SENSE A FEMALE'S GOT!

THAT'S GRUMPY! DON'T MIND HIM-- HE'S JUST A HOOMAN-WAITER--ER, A WOMAN-HATER!

2-20

OH, DEAR! AND HE LOOKS SO NICE, TOO!

I AIN'T A-FALLIN' FER THAT SOFT SOAP! ASK 'ER WHAT SHE'S A-DOIN' HERE ANYWAY!

UH--YES! YES, WHAT ARE YOU-- UH, WHO ARE YOU DOIN'--MY DEAR?

I'M SNOW WHITE--AND I RAN AWAY FROM MY WICKED STEPMOTHER, THE QUEEN!

THE QUEEN!

THAT SETTLES IT! GIT THIS FEMALE OUTA HERE AFORE WE'RE ALL KILT!

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Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs

by Walt Disney

I'M TELLIN' YA--GIT RID O' THIS FEMALE CRITTER AFORE TH' QUEEN FINDS OUT SHE'S HERE!

ARE WE AFRAID OF THE OLD QUEEN? NO!

N-NO!

CERTAINLY NOT!

WE CAN'T TURN THIS HOMELESS CHILD OUT INTO THE NARK--UH, THE DARK NIGHT!

SHE AIN'T NO CHILD--SHE'S A FEMALE AND FEMALES IS PIZEN! GIT 'ER OUT!

PLEASE LET ME STAY! THE QUEEN WILL NEVER FIND ME HERE!

SHE WON'T, HUH? SHE'S A WITCH--- FULL O' BLACK MAGIC!

SHE KIN EVEN MAKE 'ERSELF INVISIBLE! MIGHT BE IN THIS VERY ROOM--RIGHT NOW!

N-NONSENSE! THE QUEE-- THE QUEE--THE QUEEN'LL NEVER KNOW!

BUT BACK AT THE PALACE, THE QUEEN ALREADY KNOWS! HER MAGIC MIRROR HAS TOLD HER HOW SNOW WHITE ESCAPED DEATH AND IS HIDING IN THE HOME OF THE SEVEN DWARFS!

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2-27

THIS TIME THERE CAN BE NO MISTAKE! SNOW WHITE SHALL DIE BY MY OWN HAND!

Poison


Snow White
and the Seven Dwarfs
by Walt Disney
In spite of their fear of the Queen's magic powers, all the dwarfs but Grumpy have been won over by Snow White's charm.
Does she stay, men?
Yes!
No!
Stop! Please don't fight over me! I'll go!
It would have been nice if I could have stayed here! I could mend all your clothes--keep the house clean--!
Heh! Who wants it clean?
---and I'd cook for you--!
Cook? You said--cook?
Oh, yes! I can make apple dumplings---raisin cake---gooseberry pie---!
Hooray!!
All right! But, mark me--there's trouble a-brewin' when a female's around! And them pies better be mighty good!
In the dark, secret depths of her palace, the wicked Queen mixes a mysterious potion!
One drink of this magic liquid and I'll be so disguised that Snow White will never know me! Ha! She'll let me in and I'll give her something nice---!
---ah-h--ha-ha-ha! I'll give her---death!
3-6


Snow White
and the Seven Dwarfs
by Walt Disney
To further her plot against Snow White's life the Queen drinks a magic potion which changes her into an old and feeble peddler woman
Heh-heh-heh! A perfect disguise! She'll think I'm a harmless old woman---harmless! Heh-heh-heh!
And now--something to take to little Snow White! Something she'll like---ah! The very thing!
The poisoned apple---sleeping death!


One bite--and her eyes will close in the sleeping death! Then I'll be fairest in the land!
Meanwhile, the seven little men have accepted Snow White as their housekeeper and she is happily cooking their dinner
Soup!
Jiminy crickets!
Gracious! What terrible manners!
Smells good!
Dinner's not quite ready! And besides, you haven't washed yet!
W-wash?
What fer? 'Tain't new years!
Now! Now! Go right out and wash!
We ain't goin' no place!
Courage, men! It won't hurt---much!
Gosh--it's cold!
And wet, too!
Fine bunch o' water-lilies! Washin'---jest to please a woman! Heh! Like to see anybody make me wash!
Lemme go! Lemme loose, y' idjuts! You'll pay fer this!
Hold him, men! String, uh---bring him to the tub!
Souse his whiskers!
Don't spare the soap!
I'll--blub-b---you old--blubble---jest wait---glub--bub-b!
Dinner!
Hooray!
3-13

Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs

by Walt Disney

DISGUISED AS AN OLD PEDDLER WOMAN, THE WICKED QUEEN HAS PREPARED A MAGIC APPLE, WHICH SHE IS GOING TO TAKE TO SNOW WHITE ANYONE TASTING THIS APPLE FALLS INSTANTLY INTO THE "SLEEPING DEATH!"

FIRST, I'LL CALL ON HIS ROYAL HIGHNESS IN THE DUNGEON AND SHOW HIM THE TREAT FOR HIS LADY LOVE!

YOU MISERABLE, HAG! SUCH A VILE PLOT CAN NEVER SUCCEED!

HA! IT CAN'T FAIL, MY PET! THE DWARFS WILL THINK SHE'S DEAD AND THEY'LL BURY HER -- ALIVE!

HA! HA! HA! PLEASANT DREAMS, MY BOY-- PLEASANT--- DREAMS! OH-H, HA! HA! HA-A-A---!

THE DWARFS CELEBRATE THEIR FIRST EVENING WITH SNOW WHITE, WHO DANCES AND FROLICS WITH THEM, UNAWARE OF THE APPROACHING DANGER!

OH, GOODNESS! IT'S WAY PAST BEDTIME!

GOSH! I C'D DANCE ALL NIGHT-- WITH YOU!

OH, YOU COULD? WELL, YOU JUST RUN RIGHT UP TO BED--ALL OF YOU!

AHEM! MY BEER, UH-- MY DEAR PRINCESS, WE'VE ARRANGED TO SLEEP DOWN HERE! WE'LL BE VERY COMFORTABLE---YES, INDEED!

THAT'S VERY SWEET OF YOU! THANK YOU -- AND GOOD NIGHT!

3-20

NOW, UH-- MEN! KEEP COOL!

I SAW IT FIRST!

THAT'S MINE!

HEY!

LEGGO!

GET OUT!

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---AND BLESS THE LITTLE MEN WHO HAVE TAKEN ME INTO THEIR HOME AND--

--OH, YES-- PLEASE MAKE GRUMPY LIKE ME!

Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs

by Walt Disney

AT EARLY DAWN, THE WITCH-QUEEN LEAVES THE CASTLE BY A SECRET PASSAGE.....

THE MYSTERIOUS UNDERGROUND STREAM EMERGES DEEP IN THE FOREST.

HEH-HEH-HEH! THE DWARFS WILL BE AT THE MINE! SNOW WHITE LEFT ALL ALONE-- TO FALL INTO MY TRAP!

IF ONLY I COULD FREE MYSELF BEFORE THAT HAG GETS TO SNOW WHITE!

I WONDER--?

FROM THEIR FOREST HOME, SEVEN LITTLE MEN ARE LEAVING FOR THE MINE.

NOW DON'T LET ANYONE IN THE HOUSE, MY DEAR! REMEMBER--THE OLE QUEEN'S FULLA WITCHCRAFT!

DON'T WORRY-- I'LL BE ALL RIGHT!

UH--BRRHUMPH! YES, OF HORSE---COURSE! UH--COME--COME ON, MEN!

HEH! MUSHY BIZZNESS! DISGUSTIN'!

AW-W, G-O-S-H!

HRUMPH! I'M WARNIN' YA--WATCH OUT FER TH' OLE QUEEN!

WHY, GRUMPY! YOU REALLY DO CARE, DON'T YOU?

3-27

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HI-HO! HI-HO! IT'S BACK TO WORK WE GO!


Snow White
and the Seven Dwarfs
by Walt Disney
HA! THE DWARFS ARE FAR AWAY BY NOW! SNOW WHITE WILL BE ALONE!
IN THE CASTLE DUNGEON, THE PRINCE TRIES DESPERATELY TO ESCAPE IN TIME TO SAVE SNOW WHITE FROM THE POISONED APPLE!
SLEEP ONE MORE SECOND, MY FRIEND, AND I'LL BE FREE!
STOP--IN THE NAME OF THE QUEEN!
THAT FOR YOUR QUEEN!
WHAT GOES ON HERE?
MOUNTING HIS FAITHFUL HORSE, THE PRINCE COMPLETES HIS ESCAPE AND SPEEDS FOR THE FOREST!
OH-H!
DON'T BE FRIGHTENED! I'M JUST AN OLD APPLE WOMAN, DEARIE!
MY APPLES MAKE GRAND PIES--- THE KIND THE LITTLE MEN LIKE! TRY ONE, DEARIE! JUST TAKE A BITE!
IT LOOKS AWFULLY GOOD!
OH! OUCH! GET AWAY!
SHOO! STOP THAT! SHOO!
4-3


Snow White
and the Seven Dwarfs
by Walt Disney
THE BIRDS FLY DOWN AND PECK AT THE WITCH, KNOCKING THE POISONED APPLE FROM HER HAND.
SHOO! GO 'WAY! SHAME ON YOU--FRIGHTENING THE POOR OLD LADY!
OH, MY POOR HEART! TAKE ME INSIDE--LET ME REST--!
THERE--THERE--YOU'LL BE ALL RIGHT!
SENSING SNOW WHITE'S DANGER, THE BIRDS AND ANIMALS RUSH FRANTICALLY TO BRING THE DWARFS!
THE PRINCE ALSO RIDES TO THE RESCUE, SEARCHING THE FOREST FOR THE DWARFS' COTTAGE.
WHAT AILS THESE LOONY CRITTERS?
GIT AWAY, YA CRAZY FOOLS!
THEY'VE GONE PLUMB DAFFY!
THE QUEEN! MEBBE SHE'S GOT SNOW WHITE!
THAT'S IT! THEY'RE TRYIN' TO TELL US!
TO TH' RESCUE, MEN! NO TIME TO LOSE!
I'M ALL RIGHT, DEARIE! NOW DO TRY ONE OF MY APPLES! SEE WHAT DELICIOUS PIES THEY'LL MAKE!
THAT'S IT, PET---TAKE A BIG BITE!
OH! I FEEL SO---- OH-H!
HEH! HEH! HER BREATH IS STILLED---HER BLOOD CONGEALED! HEH-HEH-HEH!
4-10

Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs

by WALT DISNEY

HER EVIL PURPOSE ACCOMPLISHED, THE WITCH-QUEEN HURRIES THROUGH THE FOREST, ANXIOUS TO RESUME HER NATURAL FORM.

1

THE WITCH! THERE SHE GOES!

AFTER HER, MEN!

2

AS THE WITCH FLEES INTO THE MOUNTAINS, A STORM COMES UP.

3

CURSE THE MEDDLING FOOLS!

4

I'LL FIX YOU--- I'LL FIX YOU!

5

LOOK-- LOOK OUT, MEN!

6

HA! HA! HA! MEDDLE WITH ME, WILL YOU? I'LL CRUSH YOUR BONES!

7

SUDDENLY, A BOLT OF LIGHTNING SPLITS THE SKY---

8

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4-17

---AND THE WICKED QUEEN IS HURLED TO HER DEATH AT THE BOTTOM OF THE CHASM!

9

THE DWARFS HURRY BACK TO THEIR COTTAGE, ONLY TO FIND THAT THEY ARE TOO LATE TO SAVE THE LITTLE PRINCESS.

10

TO BE CONCLUDED

Snow White and the Seven Dwarfs

by WALT DISNEY

THINKING HER DEAD, THE DWARFS HAVE MADE A BEAUTIFUL COFFIN FOR SNOW WHITE. THEY CARRY HER TO A FOREST GLADE AND GATHER REVERENTLY AROUND HER.

I CAN HARDLY B-B' LEEVE SHE'S---DEAD!

SHE ALWAYS DID -- LOOK LIKE --- AN ANGEL!

THROUGH THE FOREST RIDES THE PRINCE, SEARCHING FOR SNOW WHITE. SUDDENLY, HE STOPS, HIS HEART CHILLED.

HE HAS FOUND HIS PRINCESS, APPARENTLY TOO LATE!

BUT SNOW WHITE IS NOT DEAD. LOVE'S FIRST KISS BREAKS THE EVIL SPELL OF THE POISONED APPLE AND SHE AWAKENS FROM HER SLEEP----

HURRAY! SNOW WHITE LIVES!

GOOD-BYE! AND THANK YOU FOR ALL YOU'VE DONE FOR ME!

GOOD-BYE, PRINCESS!

4-24

THE JOYFUL PRINCE CARRIES SNOW WHITE AWAY TO HIS CASTLE IN THE CLOUDS, WHERE THEY LIVE HAPPILY EVER AFTER!

DICK TRACY THE THIRTIES



TOMMY GUNS AND HARD TIMES

ELEVEN

OCT 16 1979

DICK TRACY THE THIRTIES



TOMMY GUNS AND HARD TIMES

Chester Gould

C. 034

Herb Galewitz, Editor

1978
Chelsea House Publishers
New York London



In the early thirties, machine guns rattled, illicit beer trucks roared down dark streets, and the hooch gangs were giving Chicago coppers a bad time. The country needed a super-sleuth—and got him in DICK TRACY by Chester Gould. The hook-nosed nemesis of the hoods launched his career of shooting down crooks and shooting up newspaper circulation.

1931-33 was an era in American history that was so devastating to so many people and to such a degree that it is hard to comprehend at a distance of almost half a century.

The newspapers were filled with horror stories: men living in the streets under a viaduct in Brooklyn; a 28-year-old man dropping dead of starvation on the sidewalks of midtown Manhattan; a sanitationman committing suicide by jumping into an incinerator because his salary was too meagre to support his family. (Can you imagine the despair of those who had no jobs?)

The President for most of this period was Herbert Hoover, who had earned a reputation as a relief savior of war-torn Belgium. But when the economic bottom fell out of his own country, Hoover had no panacea for its recovery. At least none that worked.

All sorts of nostrums were tried. Local self-help organizations were formed and some had promotional tie-ins with show biz personalities like Georgie Jessel and Mary Pickford. The media stressed the need for people to keep buying to pump-prime the economy. Soothsayers and seers were asking the populace to put their shoulders to the wheel and all would be well.

Nothing worked. A New York **News** list of the 12 best stocks of the week showed a decline in value for all. The private philanthropic organizations were overwhelmed, while the mayors of the major cities were pleading with Washington to get federal and state welfare programs in operation before thousands would starve or freeze to death. Some newspaper editorials were also wondering where governmental welfare, if it came, was going to lead, but all agreed that the situation was serious.

Back in the 1920's, with the advent of Prohibition, new modes of criminal activity were spawned. Beer barons, rumrunners and speakeasies were added to the American scene. Paved roads, faster cars, and the Thompson submachine gun were all put to use by the underworld in a quest for the quick buck.

During the relatively good economic times of the 1920's, the hoodlum capers were viewed almost with detachment by the general population. W. R. Burnett, author of the seminal **Little Caesar**, recalled two incidents from a stay in Chicago in the late 1920's. In what might today be called "snuff" radio, Burnett remembers listening to a broadcast from a local cafe, and hearing gunshots interrupt the dance music. It was a gang rub-out.

Another time, the sound of explosions awoke Burnett in his hotel room. Hurrying downstairs, he learned that a gang war was in progress between garage owners, and one of the rivals had thrown a few "pineapples" at his adversary's building across the street. Neither the hotel manager nor the garage workers were upset. It was "business as usual."

As Chester Gould states in his introduction, if you were a law-abiding citizen and didn't get involved, these criminal antics wouldn't really affect your day-to-day life.

But after that fateful day in October, 1929, when the stock market crashed, there was a



decided change in the public's attitude toward crime.

Now law-abiding citizens were without jobs or prospects, and they deeply resented the gangster who was making large illegal profits and thumbing his nose at the law while those with jobs were desperate to hold on to them.

In the early 1930's, the depression continued to deepen and kidnapping reached its all-time high (or low), to be climaxed in 1932 by the "crime of the century," the Lindbergh case. With the country in an uproar, and passions fanned by the sensationalist and mostly misleading stories in the newspapers, there was a demand for extreme penalties for all criminals. Curiously enough, the underworld was called in to aid in the capture of the Lindbergh kidnappers and the return of the baby. The "boys" failed in their efforts but they made a few bucks in the deal. (Recently in New York several Mafia types declared that they would find the "Son of Sam" murderer. They too were unsuccessful, much to the chagrin of the tabloid newspapers.)

Chester Gould, a Chicago resident at the time, was no exception. He was just as fed up with the antics of the Capones and the Roger Touhys as were most of the citizens. Perhaps even more so. For almost a decade, he had been trying to get a comic strip into the Chicago **Tribune** and national newspaper syndication. His submissions had been mainly variations on then-popular comic strips. "Fillum Fables" was his most successful strip to date, but even Gould admits that it was a weak imitation of Ed Wheelan's "Minute Movies" and didn't last too long.

By then Gould's resentment at not becoming a success, at the worsening economic situation and the burgeoning crime rate, came to a boil. Gould took out his frustrations in a new comic feature, "Plainclothes Tracy," that he sent to Captain Joseph Patterson in New York. Tracy was a cop who believed in "an eye for an eye" and fortunately Patterson, the head of the Chicago Tribune Syndicate, had the same philosophy and took Gould on. Patterson changed the name of the strip to DICK TRACY, directed Gould to "show the bullets going into the body," which became a trademark of the strip, suggested the bare bones of the first story,* and DICK TRACY was off and running.

Gould threw himself into the work with enthusiasm, but it wasn't easy, and some days he worked around the clock. Inspiration came in spurts as it does for most artists. Gould relied heavily on melodrama, and such literary devices as chance encounters, the fortuitous overhearing of important conversations, liberal use of slang and dialect speech.

We must bear in mind that there had never been anything like DICK TRACY in comic strips. The vast majority were literally "funnies," such as "Captain and the Kids," "Bringing Up Father," "Smitty," "Toonerville Trolley," "Harold Teen," and others. The only New York **News** comics with any element of realism were "Winnie Winkle," "Little Orphan Annie," "Gasoline Alley," and "The Gumps." Though some had action sequences, they were minute compared to the almost continuous gunfights and sluggings in early DICK TRACY. "The Gumps," the most popular comic strip of the Chicago Tribune Syndicate, was to go into a head-to-head battle with DICK TRACY for the front page

*Reprinted in "The Celebrated Cases of Dick Tracy" (Chelsea House, 1970)



of the New York **Sunday News**. Within two years the two comics were alternating for that vaunted position. By the time Sidney Smith (creator of "The Gumps") died in 1935, DICK TRACY moved into permanent possession of that celebrated spot, where it continues even today, though in abbreviated half-tabloid size.

In the very first story Gould had introduced three "good-guy" characters that were to be mainstays for over a decade: Chief Brandon, Tess Trueheart, and Pat Patton. It was a great beginning, and it was strong enough to carry him through most of the very important first year.

The first story in this book, "The Texie Garcia Caper," is the second story to appear in the strip. It begins as a straightforward pursuit of mobster Big Boy, but we are soon sidetracked by the attractive Texie, who is a far more interesting character, and we are into a fairly sophisticated tale of crooked lawyers and politicians.

"The Demotion of Dick Tracy" gives us a titillating view of the love life of Dick and Tess, and in reflection, a glimpse of the social mores of the early 1930's. The sight of Tracy in a bulky police overcoat nonchalantly shooting tin cans out in the sticks emphasizes how times have changed.

Broadway Bates' main claim to fame is that he bears a marked physical resemblance to the character Penguin in the Batman comic books of almost a decade later. Alas, Bates and his bob-haired girl friend, Belle, are not otherwise memorable, though Tracy will long remember the case after having a suitcase full of bricks dropped on his head. Mrs. Trueheart and Heinie, the kindly deli man, give the story some human interest, while Gould's use of silhouettes dramatically enhances the artwork.

"The Buddy Waldorf Kidnapping" was obviously inspired by the Lindbergh affair, and Tracy's beating of Big Boy is a wish fulfillment of an otherwise frustrated America.

With the "Alec Penn" and "Devil's Island" episodes Gould's inventiveness seemed to show signs of strain, as seen in plots dealing with secret rooms in a zoo, and a father who supposedly loves his daughter, but stands idly by while her life is threatened.

At best these episodes were "pauses that refreshed," for on September 8, 1932, a new character was introduced that was to give the strip the impetus to carry it to the very top of the comic world. The new arrival was a nine-year-old nameless boy. Ostensibly Dick Tracy rescues the boy and gives him his own name, but in reality Junior rescued DICK TRACY. Not only did the stories get better and far more believable, but the artwork started to improve strikingly. Appropriately enough, accompanying Junior was the first of Gould's great villains, Steve the Tramp. Today, 46 years later, old-time fans like Gil Kane, the popular comic book artist, fondly remember collecting one of the first DICK TRACY tie-ins, the Johnson caramel cards which reprinted the Steve the Tramp and "Stooge" Viller sequence. The introduction a little later of "Stooge" Viller, another great Gould creation, emphasized the fact that the author was now in full control.

Junior, always appealing in his checkered knickers, attracted the young, the old and all in between. The comic now became a must in the homes of millions of youngsters who badgered their parents to get the paper with DICK TRACY. Without a doubt, the comics were vital in maintaining the New York **News** as the largest circulating newspaper in the U.S. for a long time.

Published in this book for the first time anywhere are the five daily strips that Chester Gould sent to Captain Patterson of the Chicago Tribune-New York News Syndicate for consideration as a new comic feature.

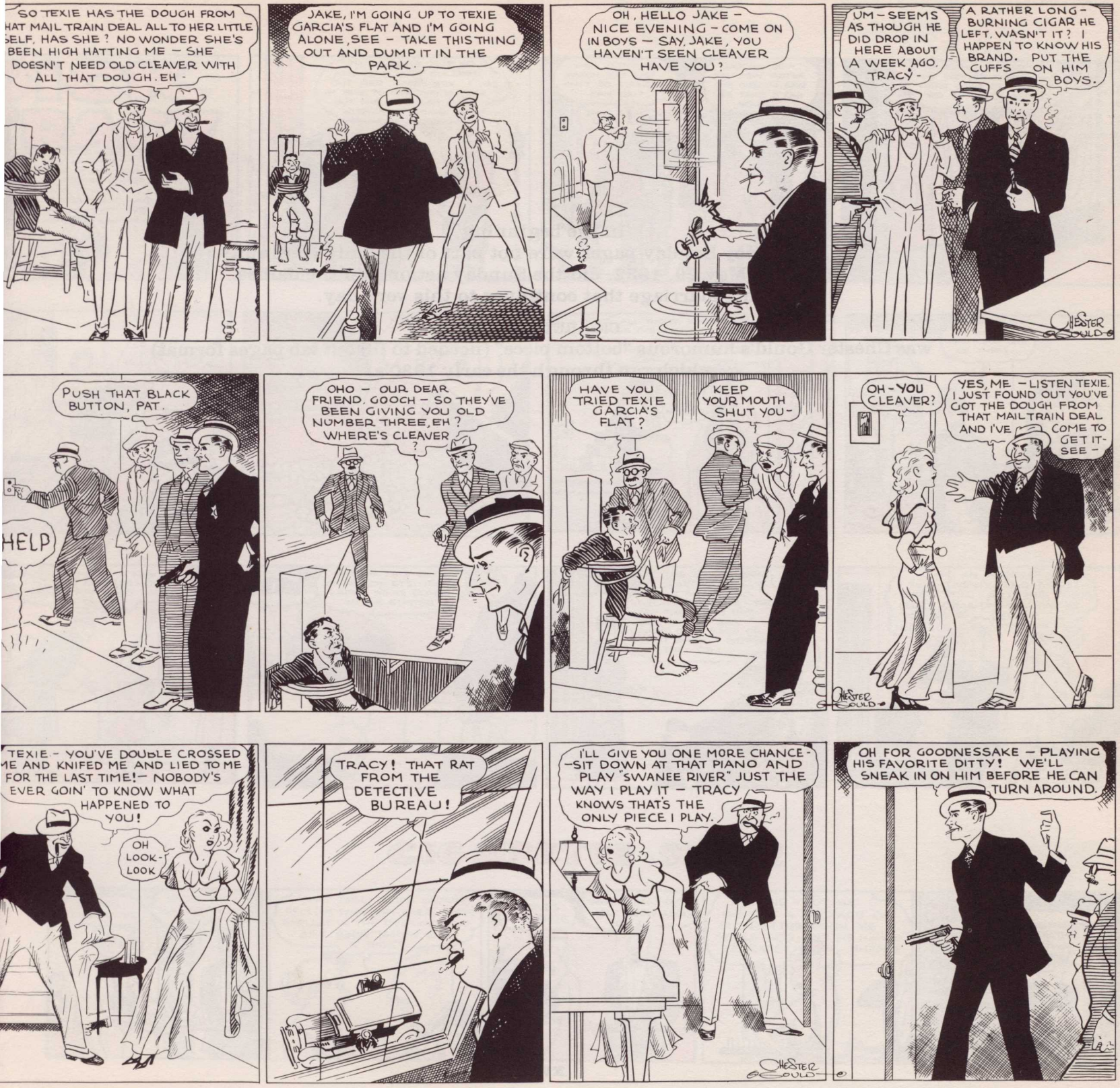


Chester Gould

"PLAIN CLOTHES TRACY"






SO TEXIE HAS THE DOUGH FROM HAT MAIL TRAIN DEAL ALL TO HER LITTLE SELF, HAS SHE? NO WONDER SHE'S BEEN HIGH HATTING ME — SHE DOESN'T NEED OLD CLEAVER WITH ALL THAT DOUGH. EH -
JAKE, I'M GOING UP TO TEXIE GARCIA'S FLAT AND I'M GOING ALONE, SEE - TAKE THIS THING OUT AND DUMP IT IN THE PARK.
OH, HELLO JAKE - NICE EVENING - COME ON IN BOYS — SAY, JAKE, YOU HAVEN'T SEEN CLEAVER HAVE YOU?
UM - SEEMS AS THOUGH HE DID DROP IN HERE ABOUT A WEEK AGO, TRACY -
A RATHER LONG - BURNING CIGAR HE LEFT, WASN'T IT? I HAPPEN TO KNOW HIS BRAND. PUT THE CUFFS ON HIM BOYS.
CHESTER GOULD
PUSH THAT BLACK BUTTON, PAT.
HELP
OHO - OUR DEAR FRIEND, GOOCH - SO THEY'VE BEEN GIVING YOU OLD NUMBER THREE, EH? WHERE'S CLEAVER?
HAVE YOU TRIED TEXIE GARCIA'S FLAT?
KEEP YOUR MOUTH SHUT YOU -
OH - YOU CLEAVER?
YES, ME - LISTEN TEXIE. I JUST FOUND OUT YOU'VE GOT THE DOUGH FROM THAT MAIL TRAIN DEAL AND I'VE COME TO GET IT - SEE -
CHESTER GOULD
TEXIE - YOU'VE DOUBLE CROSSED ME AND KNIFED ME AND LIED TO ME FOR THE LAST TIME! - NOBODY'S EVER GOIN' TO KNOW WHAT HAPPENED TO YOU!
OH LOOK - LOOK
TRACY! THAT RAT FROM THE DETECTIVE BUREAU!
I'LL GIVE YOU ONE MORE CHANCE - SIT DOWN AT THAT PIANO AND PLAY "SWANEE RIVER" JUST THE WAY I PLAY IT - TRACY KNOWS THAT'S THE ONLY PIECE I PLAY.
CHESTER GOULD
OH FOR GOODNESSAKE - PLAYING HIS FAVORITE DITTY! WE'LL SNEAK IN ON HIM BEFORE HE CAN TURN AROUND.